Md. Asiful Haque Tomal

Researcher: Geography and Environment, Socio-Hydrology, Ethnography and Disaster

Photographer: Nature, Landscape, Macro, Street, Still Life, Portrait and Events

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PROFILE

Geographer and MSc candidate in Geography and Environment at Pabna University of Science and Technology (PUST), researching how riverine communities in Bangladesh cope with riverbank erosion and floods. Over three years of field research in Kurigram, Bogura and Sirajganj districts, including fieldwork for a JSPS-funded international project. Skilled in mixed-method survey design, participatory methods (KIIs, FGDs, PRA), GIS mapping and resilience-index analysis. One journal manuscript accepted in principle, one submitted, and findings presented at three conferences, one of them international.

Research interests: natural hazards, riverbank erosion, flood defenses, livelihood vulnerability, community resilience, cultural geography.

EDUCATION

MSc in Geography and Environment (in progress) **Sep 2025 – Present**
Pabna University of Science and Technology, Pabna

Thesis: *Failure Hotspots in Engineered Flood Defenses: Evidence from Breaching of the Brahmaputra Right Embankment and Its Socio-Economic Consequences.*

BSc in Geography and Environment CGPA 3.35 / 4.00 **Jan 2020 – Sep 2025**
Pabna University of Science and Technology, Pabna

Research project: *Resilience Capacity Assessment of Brahmaputra-Jamuna Char Dwellers due to Riverbank Erosion Hazards: A case of Sariakandi Upazila, Bogura District* (Apr 2024 – May 2025).

Higher Secondary Certificate (HSC), Science GPA 4.75 / 5.00 **2017 – 2019**
Govt. Azizul Haque College, Bogura

Secondary School Certificate (SSC) GPA 5.00 / 5.00 **2012 – 2017**
Durgahata High School, Bogura

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant – *RTTC-funded research project, PUST* **Sep 2025 – Aug 2026**

Assessing Riverbank Erosion-Induced Livelihood Vulnerability using LVI, GIS, and DSAS: Evidence from Begumganj Union, Ulipur, Kurigram. Funded by the Research and Technology Transfer Cell (RTTC), PUST (FY 2025–26, Phase II); Project Director: Md. Abrar Tazwar Rijon, Lecturer, Dept. of Geography and Environment, PUST.

- Designed survey instruments and collected household survey data (n = 278), KIIs and FGDs in Begumganj Union, Ulipur, Kurigram
- Ran GIS and DSAS shoreline analysis and mapped riverbank erosion patterns (2017–2026)
- Wrote the literature review; handled data entry, statistical analysis and documentation of results

Research Assistant – *UGC-funded research project, PUST* **Jul 2024 – Jul 2025**

Livelihood Vulnerability of Riverine People in the Context of Flood Impacts: A Case Study of Kurigram District of Bangladesh.

- Conducted field surveys across flood-affected riverine communities in Kurigram District
- Produced GIS maps of flood impact zones and vulnerable settlements
- Led the literature review, wrote key report sections and built the result graphs and charts

Research Assistant – *JSPS-funded international project, Aoyama Gakuin University, Tokyo* **2023 – 2024**

Solar Pump Irrigation in South Asia: Impact on Irrigation Efficiency, Income Distribution, and Environmental Sustainability (2022–2027), led by Dr. Koichi Fujita, Professor of Economics; funded by the Japan Society for the Promotion of Science.

- Pilot-tested survey tools and prepared field logistics
- Administered structured questionnaires and in-depth interviews as a field enumerator
- Facilitated KIIs, FGDs and PRA sessions and led communication with local stakeholders
- Entered and cleaned survey data and reconciled qualitative field notes for quality assurance

JOURNAL MANUSCRIPTS

Tomal, M. A. H., Islam, M. N.*, & Rahman, M. A. Assessing community resilience to Brahmaputra-Jamuna riverbank erosion using a multidimensional Erosion Disaster Resilience Index: Evidence from Sariakandi, Bangladesh. *Journal of Hazards, Risk and Resilience* (Scilight Press). Manuscript ID JHRR-26070270, submitted 28 July 2026. **Accepted in principle, pending ethics approval.**

Rijon, M. A. T., Rahman, O., **Tomal, M. A. H.**, Hossain, M. F.*, & Ahmed, L. Flood risk mapping and livelihood vulnerability of riverine communities: A machine learning and LVI-based approach in Northern Bangladesh. *International Journal of Disaster Risk Reduction* (Elsevier). **Submitted 21 October 2026.**

CONFERENCE PROCEEDINGS (ABSTRACTS)

Islam, M., Islam, M. N., & **Tomal, M. A. H.*** (2026). Community-based anticipatory actions and needs assessment for the Brahmaputra-Jamuna riverbank erosion: Evidence from Shahjadpur Upazila under Sirajganj District in Bangladesh. In *Proceedings of the International Conference on Emerging Frontiers in Advanced Sciences and Technologies 2026 (EFAST-2026)*, Paper ID 419. PUST & Universiti Malaysia Perlis. ISBN 978-984-37-0635-5. Presented 27–28 June 2026, Pabna.

Tomal, M. A. H., Islam, M. N., & Rahman, M. A. (2026). Assessing socio-economic impacts of riverbank erosion among the char dwellers at Sariakandi in Bogura District. In *Volume of Abstracts, National Conference on Environmental Reforms in Bangladesh: Necessity and Task* (p. 128). BAPA & BEN. Presented 9–10 January 2026, Krishibid Institution Bangladesh, Dhaka.

Tomal, M. A. H., & Islam, M. N. (2025). Assessing resilience to riverbank erosion: A case study of char dwellers in Sariakandi, Bogura, Bangladesh. In *Conference Proceedings, 1st National Conference on Towards a Sustainable Future: Economic Stability, Political Reforms and Socio-Cultural Transformations in Bangladesh*. Faculty of Humanities and Social Science, PUST. Presented 28 June 2025, Pabna.

* Corresponding author

HONOURS AND AWARDS

Oct 2026	**2nd Place**, Extempore Speech – *Nazrul Year Celebration 2026, PUST*
Aug 2025	**1st Place**, Speech Competition – *Tarunner Utsob (Youth Festival) 2025, District Government Public Library, Pabna*
Jul 2025	**3rd Place (joint)**, Recitation Competition – *Tarunner Utsob (Youth Festival) 2025, District Government Public Library, Pabna*
Feb 2025	**1st Place**, Extempore Speech and **1st Place**, Book Reading Competition – *National Library Day 2025, District Government Public Library, Pabna*
Oct 2024	**3rd Best Campus Ambassador** – *FOREWARN Bangladesh Disaster Hackathon 2.0, Start Network*
Mar 2024	**Winner**, "Theme Campus" Photography Competition – *Pixel Poetry, PUST Photographic Society*
Sep 2023	**First Runner-Up**, as Team Lead (Team Conqueror) – *FOREWARN Bangladesh Disaster Hackathon 1.0, Start Network & Open Mapping Hub – Asia Pacific (HOT)*

TRAINING AND WORKSHOPS

Oct 2026	**Training on Data Analysis Software (NVivo)** – *Dept. of Business Administration, PUST (HEAT Sub-Project, PIN-13439)*
Jul 2026	**Using Generative AI in Manuscript Preparation** (certified course) – *Elsevier Researcher Academy*
Nov 2025	**Environmental Management Systems** (day-long training) – *Dept. of Geography and Environment, PUST & AJA Bangladesh*
Nov 2025	**Wikimedia Workshop 2025**: two-day training on contributing to Bangla Wikipedia, Wikisource and Wikimedia Commons, Kushtia – *Wikimedia Bangladesh & Ashru Archive*
Sep 2023	**3-day residential prototype-development workshop**, Disaster Hackathon 1.0 (open mapping, OpenStreetMap and open-source tools) – *Start Network & Open Mapping Hub – Asia Pacific (HOT)*

LEADERSHIP AND MEMBERSHIPS

2026 – Present	**Associate Editor, Fiction Section** – *Kothar Kagoj (arts and literature magazine)*
2024 – 2026	**Vice-President** – *Green Voice, PUST*
2023 – 2025	**Additional General Secretary** (2024–25); **Joint Office Secretary** (2023–24) – *Chitro – Fine Art Society of PUST*
2024 – 2025	**Vice-President** – *PUST Photographic Society*
2023 – 2025	**President** (2024–25); **Finance Secretary** (2023–24) – *Konthoswor Abbritti Dol (recitation organization), PUST*
2022 – 2024	**Assistant Secretary** – *University & Medical Students Association, Gabtoli, Bogura*

CREATIVE WRITING

2026	12 Bengali poems published online on FictionFactory; *Cafeteria* chosen as Editor Featured (26 Sep 2026)
2026	Five poems published in *Kothar Kagoj* (arts and literature magazine), Barsha 1433 issue (August 2026), pp. 23–24
2021	Three poems published in *Shat Rong* (joint poetry anthology), ed. Rudro Md. Shamim. Nobo Shahitto Prokashoni, Dhaka; ISBN 978-984-95423-3-9, pp. 92–93

SKILLS

Research	Field survey design, primary data collection, KIIs, FGDs, PRA, data cleaning and analysis, literature review, academic writing
GIS	ArcGIS, spatial analysis, thematic mapping
Software	Microsoft Office, Adobe Lightroom, Adobe Photoshop, Canva, PixelLab, CapCut, Snapseed
Languages	Bengali (native); English (professional working proficiency: academic reading, writing and speaking)
Interests	Reading fiction and non-fiction, photography (nature, street, landscape, portrait, macro), poetry recitation

REFERENCES

Dr. Mohammad Najmul Islam
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